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Service Assurance and Escalation Manual: VI Business (India)

1. Executive Purpose and Document Scope

The Service Assurance and Escalation Manual formalizes the rigid, time-bound hierarchy executed by VI Business (India) Operations when an enterprise customer experiences a severe degradation of connectivity, security, or mobility services.

This artifact proves to enterprise CIOs that issue resolution is systematically guaranteed via an escalation matrix, completely eliminating reliance on "best effort" responses. It is paramount for securing high-availability contracts in the BFSI, ITES, and continuous-manufacturing sectors.

2. Definitions, Assumptions, and Applicability

Definitions:

- **MTTR:** Mean Time To Resolve.
- **NOC/SOC:** Network/Security Operations Center.
- **P1/P2/P3/P4:** Priority/Severity classifications.

Assumptions:

- All escalation timers commence at Ticket Creation (T=00:00) within the VI ServiceNow ITSM platform, regardless of whether the ticket was auto-generated by the NOC or manually raised by the Customer Service Desk.
- "Resolution" indicates service restoration (e.g., routing traffic over a secondary LTE path). It does not guarantee immediate physical hardware or fiber repair.

Applicability:

- **Target Audience:** Bid Writers, Service Delivery Managers (SDMs), Major Incident Managers (MIM).
- **Scope:** The entire VI Business Enterprise Managed Services portfolio (SD-WAN, MPLS, VoIP, IoT, SOC).

3. Severity Framework

Incidents are strictly categorized based on the scope of business impact, not simply technical complexity.

Severity Level	Definition & Business Impact	Target Initial Response	Target Resolution (MTTR)

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Priority 1 (Critical)	Complete loss of service at a Core/Hub site. Total disruption of customer business operations (e.g., Data Center isolated).	15 Minutes	4 Hours
Priority 2 (High)	Severe degradation or total outage at a single large branch impacting >50 users. Core redundancy compromised (e.g., Primary MPLS down, running on Backup ILL).	30 Minutes	6 Hours
Priority 3 (Medium)	Minor degradation, slow response times, or outage at a small retail site with active failover holding. No immediate business stoppage.	2 Hours	Next Business Day
Priority 4 (Low)	Informational requests, reporting queries, or scheduled Change Request (CR) initiation.	4 Hours	3 Business Days

4. Escalation Timelines and Contact Roles

If the L1/L2 NOC cannot restore service within the defined MTTR, an automated, hierarchical notification triggers via email and SMS to both internal VI leadership and designated customer contacts.

Time from Incident (P1)	Auto-Escalation Level	Internal VI Business Role	Action Mandated
T + 1 Hour	Level 1 Escalation	Shift Lead (NOC/SOC)	Reallocate L2 resources. Assess routing alternatives.
T + 2 Hours	Level 2 Escalation	Service Delivery Manager (SDM)	Initiate Customer Communication Bridge.
T + 4 Hours (SLA Breach)	Level 3 Escalation	Regional Operations Head	Authorize unconstrained field dispatch overtime.
T + 8 Hours	Level 4 Escalation	National Head of Service Ops	Direct intervention. OEM (Cisco/Fortinet) TAC bridged.

5. War-Room Activation (Major Incident Management)

For systemic P1 outages (e.g., a major hyperscaler peering failure impacting 50+ customer sites simultaneously), the Major Incident Management (MIM) workflow triggers.

- **Activation Trigger:** The NOC Shift Lead formally declares a "Major Incident" in ServiceNow.
- **The War-Room:** A dedicated WebEx/Teams bridge is instantiated via API within 5 minutes.
- **Participation Rule:** The War Room is strictly restricted to Level 3 SMEs, the MIM Commander, and specific OEM TAC engineers. *Customer IT personnel and Account Managers are explicitly barred from this bridge to allow unhindered technical focus.*
- **Parallel Communication Bridge:** A secondary bridge is hosted by the SDM exclusively to brief customer stakeholders every 30 minutes.

6. Customer Communication Model

Transparency during an outage prevents panic and preserves the commercial relationship.

- **P1 Cadence:** The NOC/SDM will issue a formal status update via email every 60 minutes until the service is restored or an effective workaround is implemented.
- **RFO (Reason For Outage):** An initial, concise statement explaining *what* failed (e.g., "JCB excavation cut dual-fiber ring at 12.5 KM mark"). Issued within 2 hours of Service Restoration.

7. Root Cause Management and Recovery Governance

VI Business differentiates between restoring the service (Incident Management) and fixing the underlying flaw (Problem Management).

- **Root Cause Analysis (RCA):** For every P1/P2 outage, the Problem Management team conducts a full "5-Whys" forensic analysis.
- **Delivery Mechanism:** A formal PDF RCA report detailing the outage timeline, the root technical cause, and the preventative actions applied is emailed to the customer's CIO/IT Director within 3 Business Days.
- **Recovery Governance:** If an SLA breach occurred, the internal Billing Operations team automatically initiates the calculation for Service Credits to be applied against the next invoice cycle, bypassing the need for the customer to formally "claim" the penalty.

8. Constraints, Exclusions, and Dependency Notes

- **Customer Hold (Pending Status):** Escalation timers and MTTR SLAs are strictly paused (Status: 'Pending Customer') if the VI NOC requires the customer to perform a mandatory action (e.g., power-cycle the router, grant building access to a Field Engineer) and the customer delays. The timer resumes only when the action is completed.

9. Proposal-Use Guidance

- **SLA Defense during RFPs:** When a customer demands an unrealistic "2-Hour MTTR for all sites," rely heavily on Section 3 to gently enforce reality. Explain that a rural 4G failover site is a P3, while their Data Center is a P1, justifying differentiated SLAs.
- **Demonstrating Maturity:** Copy the entire table from Section 4 into the RFP "Support Matrix" section. Naming specific roles (like the Major Incident Manager) heavily outscores generic vendor responses like "We have a 24/7 helpdesk."

10. Governance and Ownership

- **Owner:** National Head of Service Operations
- **Reviewers:** PMO Director, Head of Enterprise Legal.
- **Update Cadence:** Evaluated annually, ensuring alignment with the latest ITSM tooling automations.